

Your Finance Dashboard — A Friendly How-To Guide 💰

Welcome! This is your personal money dashboard. It lives right on your computer and helps you see everything in one place: what you're spending, what you're saving, how your investments are doing, and whether you're on track for your goals.

This guide walks you through it step by step, in plain English. No tech background needed. Take it one section at a time — you don't have to read it all at once.

A few things to know first

- **Everything stays on your computer.** Your financial information is saved in a single file on your own machine. It's never uploaded to the cloud or shared with anyone.
 - **You can't really break anything.** If something looks wrong, you can almost always delete it and try again. Don't be afraid to click around.
 - **The AI features are optional, but highly recommended.** Written insights, the chat assistant, automatic statement reading, and smart categorization all need a one-time API key setup — and they make the dashboard significantly more useful. Without them, you're manually entering and categorizing everything yourself. We'll cover the setup below; it only takes a minute.
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Step 1: Set up your AI key (do this once)

Why bother? The dashboard works fine on its own, but a few of the nicest features — plain-English insights about your spending, a chat you can ask money questions, and the ability to *automatically read* your bank and credit card statements — need one quick setup step.

What you'll need: An AI API key. Don't let the name scare you — it's just a password-like code that lets the app use an AI service on your behalf. You get one from either Anthropic (Claude) or OpenAI (ChatGPT), and you paste it in once. Pick whichever you prefer; both work the same way inside the app.

Option A: Claude (Anthropic)

1. Go to console.anthropic.com and create an account (or log in).
2. Go to **Settings** → **API Keys** → click **Create Key** → copy the key (it starts with `sk-ant-...`).
3. Add a few dollars of credits under **Settings** → **Billing** → **Add credits** — \$5 lasts months for personal use.

4. In the dashboard: click **Settings** (top-right ⚙), set **AI Provider** to **Claude**, paste your key, and click **Save Key**.

Option B: ChatGPT (OpenAI)

1. Go to platform.openai.com and create an account (or log in).
2. Click your avatar → **API Keys** → **Create new secret key** → copy the key (it starts with `sk-...`).
3. Add credits under **Billing** → **Add to credit balance** — \$5 is plenty.
4. In the dashboard: click **Settings**, set **AI Provider** to **ChatGPT**, paste your key, and click **Save Key**.

You'll see a green **Configured** ✓ badge once your key is saved. That's it — you're done. 🎉

Is this safe? Yes. Your key is stored only on your own computer and is never shown back on screen or shared with anyone else. You can switch providers at any time in Settings.

Optional: tell it your monthly income

While you're in Settings, you can set your **Monthly Income Baseline** — basically your usual take-home pay each month. This helps the Budget Builder make better suggestions. Type the amount and click **Save**. You can skip this for now and add it later.

What do the AI features cost?

Short version: **almost nothing**. The AI features bill straight to your Anthropic or OpenAI account, and for personal use you'll likely spend just a few cents a month — often less.

Here's how it works in plain terms. The AI charges by the amount of text it reads and writes, measured in "tokens" (a token is roughly $\frac{3}{4}$ of a word). The app uses two different AI models depending on the task — a fast, cheap one for most things, and a more capable one for reading documents. You're never charged a subscription or a monthly minimum; you only pay for what you actually use.

The table below shows what each feature roughly costs **per use**. These are estimates — your real cost depends on how much data you have — but they're in the right ballpark.

What you're doing	Roughly costs	Notes
AI Insights (Dashboard & Spend Analyzer)	a fraction of a cent	Reads a summary of your transactions
Asking a follow-up in chat	a fraction of a cent	Each message is tiny
Goal analysis & goal chat	a fraction of a cent	
Re-categorize uncategorized (AI)	a fraction of a cent	
Budget Builder	about 1 cent	Reads more data, so slightly more
Auto-detecting a new CSV's columns	about 1–2 cents	Happens once per new account, then it's free

Reading a PDF statement (Vision)	about 5–15 cents	The priciest one — it "looks at" each page like an image; longer statements cost a bit more
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Want to put a hard limit on it? Both Anthropic and OpenAI let you set a monthly spending cap and see your usage on their billing dashboard, so there are no surprises. If you mostly upload CSV files instead of PDFs, your costs stay especially tiny.

Step 2: Get your money data in

Why this matters: The dashboard can only show you useful things once it knows about your transactions. The easiest way to feed it your spending is to upload a statement from your bank or credit card. You only have to teach it about each account once.

You can add data in three ways:

- **Upload a statement file** (the fast way — recommended)
- **Type transactions in by hand** (fine for one-offs)
- Let it **read a PDF statement automatically** using AI

Uploading a statement file (CSV)

A **CSV** is just a spreadsheet file your bank lets you download — usually there's a "Download" or "Export" button in your online banking, and you pick the CSV option.

1. Go to the **Finances** tab (for bank accounts) or **Spend Analyzer** tab (for credit cards).
2. Click the **Upload Bank Statement** button (or **Upload Credit Card Statement** on the Spend Analyzer tab).
3. Pick the CSV file you downloaded from your bank.

What happens next depends on whether the app has seen this account before:

If it recognizes the account (you've uploaded from it before), a little banner pops up that says *"Recognized format: [your bank's name]"*.

- Click **Yes, use it** and your transactions import right away. Done!
- Click **No, remap** only if something changed and you want to set it up again.

If it's a new account it hasn't seen, it'll try to figure out the columns for you automatically (you'll see *"Auto-detecting columns..."*). Then it shows you the transactions it found so you can look them over before importing.

If it needs your help matching things up, a small setup window appears. Don't worry, it's quick:

1. **Name this source** — give the account a friendly name like "Chase Checking" or "Amex Card." (You'll only do this once per account.)
2. **Point out the columns** — tell it which column has the **Date**, which has the **Description**, and which has the **Amount**.
 - If your bank puts deposits and withdrawals in *two separate columns*, flip on the split (Debit/Credit) option and pick both.
 - If your amounts look backwards (money out shows as a positive number), tick the **Invert amounts** box.
3. **Choose the type** — is this a **Bank / checking** account or a **Credit card**? (Bank accounts count deposits as income; credit cards only track spending.)
4. Click **Import**.

The app remembers your setup, so next time you upload from this account it'll be the quick one-click experience. ✨

Want a head start? On the *Finances* tab there's a **CSV Template** button that downloads a blank, correctly-formatted spreadsheet. Handy if you'd rather build a file by hand.

Uploading a PDF statement (let the AI read it)

No spreadsheet available? No problem. If your bank only gives you a PDF, the app can read it for you. (This is one of the features that needs an AI key from Step 1.)

1. Click the same **Upload Bank Statement / Upload Credit Card Statement** button.
2. Choose your PDF file.
3. You'll see *"analyzing with AI..."* while it reads the document — give it a few seconds.
4. A **Review** window opens showing every transaction it found, plus a quick summary of total income (green) and total spending (red).
5. Look it over. See a row that doesn't belong? Click the **X** next to it to remove it.
6. Type a name for the account in the **Bank / source name** box.
7. Click **Import** and you're done.

If something looks wrong: AI reads clean, table-style statements best. If it misses things or grabs the wrong numbers, just delete the bad rows before importing — or, if it's really off, cancel and try the CSV method instead.

Typing a transaction by hand

Sometimes you just want to add one thing — a cash purchase, say. On either the **Finances** or **Spend Analyzer** tab, click **+ Add Transaction**, fill in the date, description, and amount, pick a category, and save. Quick and easy.

The Dashboard — your big-picture view

What it's for: This is your home base — a single glance that answers "how am I doing?" You don't *do* much here; you just see a lot.

Here's what you'll find:

- **Net Worth** — your total wealth (everything you own, like cash, savings, and investments). Green is good.
- **Cash Balance** — money on hand. See a little  pencil next to it? Click it, type your current cash, and save to keep it accurate.
- **Portfolio Value** — what your investments are worth right now, using live stock prices. (It may say *"Fetching..."* for a moment while it looks up prices.)
- **Net Worth Over Time** — a chart showing whether your wealth is trending up or down. Use the period buttons to zoom in: **3M / 6M / 1Y / YTD / All**. It fills in as you use the app, so it may look empty at first — that's normal.
- **Net Worth Breakdown** — a colorful donut showing how your money is split between cash, savings, and different investment types.
- **Monthly Net Cash Flow** — a bar chart showing months where you earned more than you spent (green) versus months where spending exceeded income (red). Use the period buttons (**3M / 6M / 1Y / YTD / All**) to zoom in or see your full history at once.
- **Goal Progress** — a quick look at how close you are on each savings goal.

Get AI insights (and ask questions)

If you set up your AI key, scroll to the **AI Insights** card and click **Generate Insights**. In a few seconds you'll get a few plain-English observations about your money (like "You spent 35% of your budget on groceries this month").

Below that, there's a chat box. Type a real question — "Where am I overspending?" — and press **Send** to get an answer. Want fresh insights later? Just click **Refresh**.

No key set up yet? You'll see a note inviting you to add one in Settings. Everything else on the Dashboard still works.

Finances — your bank account

What it's for: This tab is all about your **bank account** — your paycheck coming in, your rent and bills going out, money you move to savings. It's the income-and-expenses side of your life.

What you can do here:

- **See the big picture** — charts compare your income against your expenses, with running totals on the side.
 - **Change the time window** — use the period buttons (**7D / 1M / 3M / 6M / 1Y / YTD / All**) at the top to zoom in on a recent week or stretch out to your full history.
 - **Add a transaction** — click **+ Add Transaction** for anything you want to enter by hand.
 - **Upload a statement** — the **Upload Bank Statement** button (see [Step 2](#) above).
 - **Tidy up your transaction list** — the table at the bottom shows every transaction:
 - **Change a category** — click the colored category tag and pick a better one.
 - **Link a savings transfer to an account** — for money you moved to savings, click **+ Link account** to connect it to one of your savings accounts.
 - **Delete something** — click the **X** on its row.
 - **Filter the view** — use the dropdowns to show just one month, or filter by type: **Income**, **Expenses**, **Savings** (transactions categorized as Savings), or **Investments** (contributions to investment accounts).
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Spend Analyzer — your credit card spending

What it's for: This is your **credit card** detective. It helps you see exactly where your money goes — which stores, which categories — and lets you dig into spending patterns.

The basics

- **Upload your card statement** with the **Upload Credit Card Statement** button (same process as [Step 2](#)).
- **Explore the charts** — see your spending broken down by card, by category, and a **Top Merchants** list showing where the most money went.
- **Search and sort** — use the search box to find a specific purchase, or click a column header to sort the list.

Tidy up your categories

Good categories make everything else more useful. In the transaction table:

- Click any **category tag** to change it.

- Got transactions with no category? Click the **Uncategorized only** button to see just those, then fix them.
- In a hurry? Click **Re-categorize uncategorized** and the AI will sort them for you (needs your AI key).

Insights and chat

Just like the Dashboard, there's a **Generate Insights** button and a chat box here too — ask things like *"What should I cut to save more this month?"*

Budget — your spending limits & savings plan

What it's for: This tab is your financial plan in one place. Set caps on what you spend by category, see how you're tracking against those limits in real time, and set savings targets alongside your spending — all on one screen.

Spending caps

The budget table shows each spending category with:

- **Your limit** — click any amount to edit it directly.
- **Your average** — what you've actually been spending per month (from your credit card history).
- **Progress bar** — fills up as you spend. Turns **yellow** as you approach your limit and **red** if you go over.
- **% of income** — a label like **\$400 (8%)** next to each figure so you can gut-check whether a category is taking a reasonable share of your pay.

Savings & goals section

Below the spending table you'll find a separate teal-shaded section for money you're *putting away*:

- **Savings / Investment categories** (e.g. Savings, Investments, Retirement) pull their average from your *bank* transactions rather than credit card history, since those contributions don't appear on a card statement.
- **Active goal rows** show how much you've committed to each goal per month. If you haven't set a monthly savings amount on a goal, the app auto-fills an estimate from your bank history and marks it *auto*.
- **General Savings Target** — a catch-all row for savings not tied to a specific goal. It defaults to **15% of your income** (marked *auto*) — no setup needed. You can override it by clicking the number and typing a specific dollar amount; clear the field to go back to the rate-based default. The small label underneath explains what's driving the current number.

Build a budget with help — the Budget Builder ✨

Why use it: Not sure what your limits *should* be? The Budget Builder looks at your actual spending and your goals, then suggests a sensible budget for you.

One thing first: you need at least one goal set up (see the [Goals](#) tab), and your uncategorized transactions should be cleaned up. The app will nudge you if either isn't ready.

1. Click the **Budget Builder** button (look for the sparkles ✨).
2. **Confirm your monthly income.** It'll pre-fill this from your Settings or from your recent deposits — adjust it if needed.
3. **Pick a pace:** **Aggressive** 🔥 (save hard), **Balanced** ⚖️, or **Comfortable** 😊 (easier on yourself).

4. **Mention any one-off expenses** to ignore, like "car repair \$1,400 in March," so they don't throw off the plan. (Optional.)
 5. Click **Generate My Budget** and wait a few seconds.
 6. **Review the suggestions.** You'll see a recommended limit for each category, plus a short explanation of the reasoning. Tweak any number you don't like.
 7. Happy with it? Click **Accept & Save Budget**. Your new limits now show up in the budget tracker above. Don't like it? Click **Start Over**.
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Investments — your stocks and savings

What it's for: Keep track of two things: your **investments** (stocks and funds) and your **savings accounts** (like a high-yield savings account earning interest).

Adding an investment

1. Click **+ Add Holding**.
2. Fill in:
 - **Ticker** — the stock's short symbol, like `AAPL` for Apple.
 - **Shares** — how many you own.
 - **Purchase Price** — what you paid per share.
 - **Purchase Date** — when you bought them.
 - **Account Type** — where it's held (a retirement account, a regular brokerage, etc.).
3. Click **Add Holding**.

The app fetches the *current* price automatically, so you can see your **gain or loss** at a glance — green if you're up, red if you're down. Bought the same stock more than once? Click the **"N buys"** label on its row to see each purchase separately.

***Heads up:** Prices are pulled live from the internet. Once in a while a lookup fails and you'll see a small error — you can dismiss it and it'll usually work next time.*

Adding a savings account

Scroll down to **Savings Accounts** and click **+ Add Account**. Enter the account's name, type, current balance, and its **APY** (the yearly interest rate it pays — your bank lists this). The app then shows you how much interest you're earning each month and each year. Need to update a balance later? Click the  pencil to edit it in place.

Goals — what you're saving toward

What it's for: This is the motivating part — set a target (an emergency fund, a vacation, a house down payment) and watch yourself get closer.

Emergency Fund Calculator

At the top of the Goals page you'll find a built-in **Emergency Fund Calculator** — a quick sanity check on whether you have enough set aside for a rainy day.

- **Pick a coverage target** — choose 3, 6, 9, or 12 months of expenses. Most financial guidance suggests 3–6 months; pick what feels right for your situation.
- The calculator uses your **average monthly spending** (from your real transactions) to work out a target dollar amount automatically.

- If you already have an "Emergency Fund" goal, it shows a progress bar combining that goal's balance *plus* your current cash balance, so you get credit for money you're already holding.
- **Gap** — the shortfall between where you are and where you want to be.
- **Create Emergency Fund Goal** — if you don't have one yet, click this button and the calculator will create a goal pre-filled with the right target amount and your current cash balance as a head start.
- **Sync target** — if your goal's target is out of date (maybe your spending changed), a small "Sync target → \$X,XXX" button appears so you can update it to match the current calculation in one click.

Create a goal

1. Click **New Goal**.
2. Fill in:
 - **Goal name** — like "Emergency Fund."
 - **Target amount** — how much you want to save.
 - **Target date** — when you'd like to hit it.
 - **Monthly savings** — how much you plan to put toward it each month (optional, but it powers the timeline estimate). If you've been saving consistently, you'll see a suggestion like "*Your avg savings: \$400/mo over 6 mo — Use this*" — click it to fill in the field automatically.
3. **Link accounts (optional but powerful)** — at the bottom of the form, you'll see a **Linked accounts** section. This lets the goal automatically track money you already have in savings accounts or investment holdings, instead of you manually adding funds.
 - Pick an account from the dropdown and enter the **percentage** of that account to count toward this goal (e.g. "50% of my High-Yield Savings").
 - You can link multiple accounts. The app caps the total at 100% per account across all goals — so two goals can't double-count the same money.
 - Click **Add** for each account, then continue.
4. Click **Create Goal**.

Each goal shows up as a card with a progress bar, the percentage you've reached, and — if you entered a monthly amount — a friendly estimate like "*~12 months to go.*"

If your goal has **linked investment accounts**, the app also factors in your average monthly investment contributions (calculated from your bank history). The card will show something like "*Saving \$600/mo (\$200 manual + \$400 avg investment contrib)*" and use the combined rate for the timeline estimate. This means you don't have to manually account for regular brokerage or retirement contributions when projecting how long a goal will take.

Keeping a goal updated

- **Linked goal?** Nothing to do — the progress bar updates automatically as your account balances and investment prices change. The card shows a breakdown ("Funded by linked accounts") listing which accounts are contributing what.
- **Unlinked goal?** Type the amount in the **Add amount...** box on the card and click **Add Funds**. The progress bar jumps forward.
- **Need to change something?** Click **Edit** to adjust the target, date, monthly savings, or linked accounts, then **Save**.
- **Want advice?** Click **Get AI Analysis** for thoughts on your goal, and use the chat box to ask things like "*How can I reach this faster?*" (needs your AI key).
- **Done with a goal?** Click **Delete** to remove it.

Growth projection

Linked goals show an extra estimate in a dashed box:

 With growth (6% return + APY), you'd reach this in ~9 months

This is an optimistic "what if" that factors in compound growth — APY on savings, and an assumed return on investments. It's shown separately from the plain timeline so you can tell them apart. You can change the assumed investment return percentage in Settings.

Settings — your preferences

What it's for: A small control panel for the handful of things you set once and forget.

- **AI Provider** — choose between **Claude** (Anthropic) and **ChatGPT** (OpenAI). Switching here changes which AI service the app uses for all features — insights, categorization, PDF parsing, and the Budget Builder.
 - **Claude API Key / OpenAI API Key** — add or replace your key for the selected provider (see [Step 1](#)). A green **Configured** ✓ badge means you're good to go.
 - **Monthly Income Baseline** — your usual take-home pay. The Budget Builder uses this to make smarter suggestions. Type it in and click **Save**.
 - **Assumed Annual Investment Return** — the return rate used for the optimistic growth projection on linked goals. Defaults to **6%**. If your holdings are mostly conservative (bonds, cash-equivalent ETFs) you might lower it; if you're in aggressive growth funds you might raise it. Savings accounts always use their own APY regardless of this setting. Type a new percentage and click **Save**.
 - **Default Savings Rate** — the percentage of your monthly income used as the automatic general savings target on the Budget page. Defaults to **15%**. For example, if your income is \$5,000 and this is 15%, the Budget page's General Savings Target row will default to \$750. You can override the dollar amount directly in the Budget table for a specific month without touching this setting — this just controls the starting default. Type a new percentage (0–100) and click **Save**.
 - **PDF Upload History** — a log of every PDF statement you've imported. If you want to re-import a statement or just keep things tidy, you can delete individual entries here.
 - **Saved CSV Sources** — a list of the bank and card accounts you've taught the app about. If an account's downloads change format and imports start looking off, delete it here and the app will re-learn it the next time you upload. You can remove them one at a time or clear them all.
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Handy tips & good-to-knows

- **Your data lives on your computer**, in a single file. If you ever want to keep a backup or move to a new computer, that one file is everything — copy it somewhere safe now and then.
 - **Money in is positive, money out is negative**. You'll see income in green and spending in red throughout the app. That's just the convention — nothing to set up.
 - **You can fix categories anywhere**. Wherever you see a colored category tag, you can click it to change it. Don't stress about getting them perfect on import — clean them up whenever.
 - **The AI is powered by your own key**. Anything the AI features do uses the key you added, and your information stays on your machine. No surprises.
 - **To stop the app**, click the **red stop icon** in the top-right corner of the nav bar (next to the Settings gear). A confirmation modal appears — click **Close App**, then **Close Tab** when it's done. No need to touch the terminal.
 - **Want to show the app to someone without exposing your real data?** Ask whoever set it up to enable Demo Mode — it loads sample data and blocks any edits, so you can click through everything safely.
 - **When in doubt, just try it**. Almost everything can be deleted and re-done. Click around and get comfortable — it's your dashboard. 😊
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Happy budgeting!